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TATTERSALLS CRAVEN BREEZE-UP SALE 2026

April 13–15, 2026 · Park Paddocks, Newmarket · Europe's Leading Breeze-Up Sale

TOTAL GROSS · SECOND HIGHEST IN SALE HISTORY

15,450,500 Guineas

-18% vs 2025 record · 113 sold · 81% clearance · 11 lots ≥ 300k gns

136,730 gns

AVERAGE -13%

100,000 gns

MEDIAN HOLDS

113

LOTS SOLD

11

≥300k LOTS (= RECORD)

SALE STATISTICS · 2026 TATTERSALLS CRAVEN BREEZE-UP SALE



"Against this backdrop, we can only be pleased that the sale has returned turnover surpassed only once in its history. We have witnessed strong competition for the best breezers, with a record-equalling eleven lots realising 300,000 guineas or more. That said, we acknowledge that the market has been selective, and the sale has not been easy for all consignors."

— MATTHEW PRIOR, Managing Director, Tattersalls · April 15, 2026

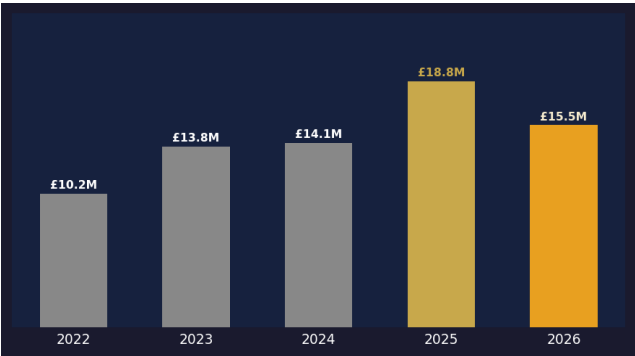


Fig 1. Total Gross (Guineas M) · Tattersalls Craven Breeze-Up 2022–2026



Fig 2. Average vs Median (Guineas) · Tattersalls Craven 2022–2026

SESSION BREAKDOWN · DAY-BY-DAY RESULTS

SESSION	DATE	SOLD	W/D	GROSS	AVERAGE	MEDIAN	CLEARANCE
Day 1	Apr 14	64	n/a	6,678,000 gns	104,344 gns	~95,000 gns	~82%
Day 2	Apr 15	49	n/a	8,772,500 gns	179,031 gns	110,000 gns	~80%
TOTAL	Apr 14-15	113	27	15,450,500 gns	136,730 gns	100,000 gns	81%

YoY 2025 comparison: 119 sold · 18,804,000 gns gross · 158,017 gns avg · 100,000 gns median · 83% clearance | 1 guinea ≈ £1.05 / US\$1.42 (Apr 2026)

TOP LOTS · ALL LOTS ≥ 300,000 GUINEAS · COMPLETE DETAILS

147	D2	Starspangledbanner Belicious (Danehill Dancer)	Egmont Stud / M.Flannery	Stroud Coleman / Victorious F...	900,000 gns	...
112	D2	Mehmas Superiority (Exceed And Excel)	Tally-Ho Stud	Blandford B'stock / R.Brown	550,000 gns	...
44	D1	Palace Pier Majmu AUS (Redoute's Choice)	Tally-Ho Stud	Blandford B'stock / Saeed Suhail	450,000 gns	...
8	D1	Lope De Vega Freely (Sea The Stars)	Kilminfoyle House Stud	Blandford B'stock / Saeed Suhail	400,000 gns	...
177	D2	No Nay Never Ein Gedi (Elnadim)	Grove Stud	R.Speers / Old Mill Stud (I.Araci)	400,000 gns	...
12	D1	Mehmas Grizzel (Shamardal)	Kilminfoyle House Stud	Stroud Coleman / Victorious F...	380,000 gns	...
16	D1	Havana Grey Hot Secret (Exceed And Excel)	Yeomanstown Stud	Stroud Coleman / Victorious F...	350,000 gns	...
146	D2	Too Darn Hot Beautiful Filly (Frankel)	Powerstown Stud	Suited & Booted Racing / P.Eb...	325,000 gns	...
n/a	D1	Starman Aretha (Halling)	Ballybush Stables (P.Va...	R.Fahey / P.Fahey	240,000 gns	...
n/a	D1	Starman Teeline (Pivotal)	N.Williamson	R.Ryan	235,000 gns	...

PINHOOK ANALYSIS · TATTERSALLS OCTOBER YEARLING → CRAVEN BREEZE-UP 2026

LOT	SIRE / HORSE	YRG COST	BU PRICE	GROSS PROFIT	ROI	VERDICT
44	Palace Pier colt	100,000 gns	450,000 gns	+350,000 gns	+350%	EXCEPTIONAL
8	Lope De Vega colt	160,000 gns	400,000 gns	+240,000 gns	+150%	STRONG
12	Mehmas filly (Grizzel)	100,000 gns	380,000 gns	+280,000 gns	+280%	EXCEPTIONAL
16	Havana Grey filly	135,000 gns	350,000 gns	+215,000 gns	+159%	STRONG
146	Too Darn Hot colt	100,000 gns	325,000 gns	+225,000 gns	+225%	EXCEPTIONAL
112	Mehmas colt (Superiority)	Not yrg. sold	550,000 gns	N/A	N/A	N/A
147	Starspangledbanner filly	Not yrg. sold	900,000 gns	N/A	N/A	N/A

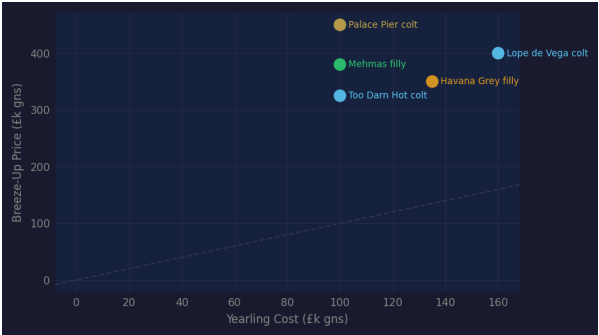


Fig 5. Pinhook ROI: Tattersalls October Yearling Cost vs Craven Breeze-Up 2026 Sale Price (lots with known yearling purchase history)

LEADING SIRES · BLOODSTOCKAI ANALYSIS

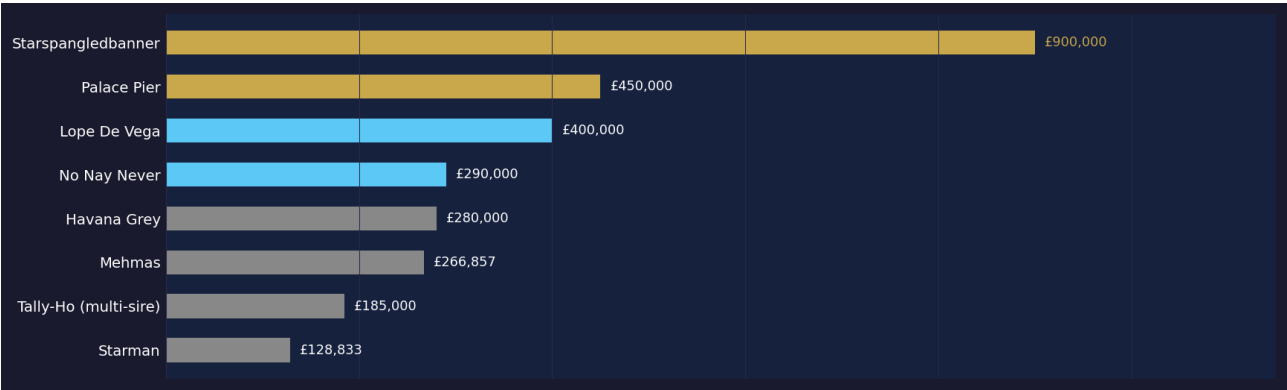


Fig 3. Leading Sires by Top Price (lots with named sire) - 2026 Tattersalls Craven Breeze-Up Sale

SIRE	STUD / COUNTRY	SOLD	AGGREGATE	AVERAGE	TOP PRICE	BL...
Mehmas	Tally-Ho Stud / IRE	7	1,868,000 gns	266,857 gns	550,000 gns	STRONG B
Starspangledbanner	Arrowfield / AUS	3	~1,150,000 gns	~383,333 gns	900,000 gns	STRONG B
Palace Pier	Banstead Manor / GB	1	450,000 gns	450,000 gns	450,000 gns	ACCUMUL
Lope De Vega	Ballylinch / IRE	1	400,000 gns	400,000 gns	400,000 gns	CUMUL
No Nay Never	Coolmore / IRE	1	400,000 gns	400,000 gns	400,000 gns	ACCUMUL
Havana Grey	Whitsbury Manor / GB	5+	~780,000 gns	~156,000 gns	350,000 gns	ONITO
Too Darn Hot	Banstead Manor / GB	2	~525,000 gns	~262,500 gns	325,000 gns	ACCUMUL
Starman	Tweenhills / GB	3	~600,000 gns	~200,000 gns	240,000 gns	ONITO

FIRST-CROP SIRES SPOTLIGHT · DEBUT CROPS AT 2026 CRAVEN BREEZE-UP

SIRE	STUD FARM	FEE	SOLD	TOP PRICE	NOTES	BLOODSTOCK...	OUTLOOK 2027
Baaeed	Shadwell Est / IRE	£80k	3+	~180,000 gns	Son of Sea Th...	ACCUMULATE	Classic potential ho...
Naval Crown	Cheveley Park / ...	£25k	2+	~90,000 gns	Multiple sprint ...	MONITOR	Sprint 2yo sire profile
Blackbeard	Coolmore / IRE	£30k	1+	~80,000 gns	Phoenix Stake...	MONITOR	Watch OBS April
Perfect Power	Tweenhills / GB	£20k	2+	~70,000 gns	July Cup/Middl...	ACCUMULATE	Strong 2yo sire profile

MEHMAS · BloodstockAI Note

With 7 sold at a 266,857 gns average off a reported €40,000 fee, Mehmas delivered the sale's outstanding sire performance for the third consecutive year. His Craven Breeze-Up alumni include Group 1 winner Believing (AI Quoz Sprint, 2025) and Hotazhell (Futurity Trophy, 2025). The Campanelle half-brother at 550,000 gns signals the market believes the cross of Mehmas over Exceed & Excel-line mares is a consistent G1-producing formula. STRONG BUY at current fees.

STARSPANGLEDBANNER · BloodstockAI Note

The Australian-based son of Fastnet Rock had limited European representation but maximum impact: the 900,000 gns Egmont Stud filly (Lot 147) was the sale's most expensive lot in a subdued market, proving buyers were prepared to go to the highest level for the right quality regardless of macro headwinds. He sired two Cartier Champion 2-Year-Olds in 2025 — a unique achievement. The scarcity of European-based Starspangledbanner offspring creates an arbitrage opportunity: Australian-bought weanlings repinhooking through Craven.

BREEZE INTELLIGENCE · APRIL 13, 2026 · ROWLEY MILE RACECOURSE, NEWMARKET

The breeze for the 2026 Tattersalls Craven Breeze-Up Sale took place on Monday April 13 on the Rowley Mile Racecourse — the only breeze-up sale in Europe conducted on an official Group 1 racecourse. The 2026 sale was framed by considerable external uncertainty: the outbreak of conflict in the Middle East created market trepidation, with several prominent buyers absent from the Park Paddocks bench. Against this backdrop, the horses that stood out in the breeze received vigorous competition, with the top of the market remaining robust. Matthew Prior noted the "selective" nature of demand — a structural bifurcation that separated genuinely elite breeders from the rest of the catalogue.

FASTEST BREEZING PERFORMERS · STANDOUT PERFORMANCES AT ROWLEY MILE

LOT	SIRE	DAM (SIRE OF DAM)	CONSIGNOR	BREEZE NOTE	PRICE	...
147	Starspangledbanner	Belicious (Danehill Da...	Egmont Stud	Foot perfect all week; consist...	900,000 gns	...
44	Palace Pier	Majmu AUS (Redoute'...	Tally-Ho Stud	Strong; powered through the r...	450,000 gns	...
112	Mehmas	Superiority (Exceed & ...	Tally-Ho Stud	Exceptional; examiners unani...	550,000 gns	...
8	Lope De Vega	Freely (Sea The Stars)	Kilminfoyle House Stud	Fluent mover; showed speed ...	400,000 gns	...
12	Mehmas	Grizzel (Shamardal)	Kilminfoyle House Stud	Bred same as Believing; elite ...	380,000 gns	...
16	Havana Grey	Hot Secret (Exceed & ...	Yeomanstown Stud	Similar profile to Vandeeke; Kh...	350,000 gns	...
177	No Nay Never	Ein Gedi (Elnadim)	Grove Stud	Good enough to stretch for; R...	400,000 gns	...
146	Too Darn Hot	Beautiful Filly (Frankel)	Powerstown Stud	Half-brother Raven's Corner t...	325,000 gns	...

BREEZE FORMAT · ROWLEY MILE UNIQUE ADVANTAGES & 2026 CONDITIONS

ROWLEY MILE ADVANTAGE — RISING FINISH

The Rowley Mile's rising finish (1 in 30 gradient over the final furlong) separates genuine thoroughbreds from horses that merely have speed. Horses that maintain stride rhythm through the dip and up the hill demonstrate the athleticism required for Newmarket racing. Richard Brown specifically cited this for the Palace Pier colt: "When he hit the rising ground he came out powerfully — that is a good sign." It is the single most diagnostic breeze venue in Europe.

SINGLE BREEZE FORMAT — NO SECOND CHANCE

Unlike multi-day formats at other sales, Craven offers a single breeze on the Monday before the two-day sale. This concentrates buyer attention on one performance. The "foot perfect all week" narrative for the Starspangledbanner filly underscores that consignors' homework in the days preceding the breeze is as important as the breeze itself.

MIDDLE EAST CONTEXT — MARKET RESILIENCE UNDER STRESS

The 2026 sale was the first major European bloodstock event following the outbreak of conflict in the Middle East. Several key buyers from the region were absent or participated at reduced levels. The fact that turnover still reached 15.45M gns — second highest in sale history — and that Victorious Forever (Bahrain) remained the dominant buyer, demonstrates exceptional structural resilience in the market for elite breeze-up stock.

CATALOGUE FORMAT DEBATE — CONSIGNOR FEEDBACK

TDN reported widespread consignor feedback that the two-evening format (split across racing days) made the 2026 sale "long and drawn out." The absence of a concentrated single-day selling session may have depressed middle-market results. Tattersalls may need to consider whether the current format serves all price tiers or primarily benefits the top 20% of lots.

LEADING BUYERS · TOP 5 BY AGGREGATE SPEND

BUYER / PRINCIPAL	AGENT	LOTS	SPEND	NOTABLE PURCHASE	BUYER PROFILE
Victorious Forever (Bahrain)	A.Stroud / Stroud C...	4	1,810,000 gns	L147 Starspangledbanner 900k	Bahrain royals...
Blandford Bloodstock	Richard Brown	4+	~1,850,000 gns	L44 Palace Pier 450k	R.Brown domi...
Old Mill Stud / I.Araci	Rob Speers	1	400,000 gns	L177 No Nay Never filly 400k	Owner of Akta...
Saeed Suhail	Richard Brown	2	~800,000 gns	L8 Lope De Vega 400k	First-ever bree...
Suited & Booted Racing	Paul Ebbs (syndicate)	1	325,000 gns	L146 Too Darn Hot 325k	Dubai-based s...

INTERNATIONAL BUYER PRESENCE · GLOBAL DEMAND INDICATORS

MIDDLE EAST [BAHRAIN / SAUDI — LEVEL: HIGH DESPITE HEADWINDS]

Victorious Forever (the merged racing operation of Bahrain brothers Shaikh Nasser and Shaikh Khalid) was the dominant buyer at 1.81M gns across 4 lots, including the 900,000 gns sale topper. Stroud confirmed "Shaikh Khalid takes a lot of interest in the breeze up and has had enormous success." Their consistent presence — through KHK Racing, now Victorious Forever — has been the structural backbone of Craven's top-end prices since 2021. Absence of some Saudi buyers (geopolitical context) was more than offset by Bahraini commitment; the net Middle East footprint remains the sale's single most important buyer cohort.

HONG KONG [LEVEL: MEDIUM — STABLE]

Hong Kong-based interests (unnamed) were confirmed by Matthew Prior as present at the sale. The Jockey Club's strict quarantine and import rules limit active buying to agents with established European conduits, but the Craven's track record of producing early 2-year-olds fits the Hong Kong preference for precocious sprinters. No individual purchase identified publicly but consignors reported Asian interest on several mid-range lots.

AUSTRALIA [LEVEL: MEDIUM — GROWING]

Australian connections present per Matthew Prior. Breednet and TTR AusNZ's detailed coverage of the sale reflects the growing Australian investment community tracking European breeze-up results. The Starspangledbanner filly purchase (Bahraini-owned but Australian sire) and the Australian-bred Palace Pier dam (Majmu, Redoute's Choice) underscore the trans-hemisphere pedigree flows that make Craven increasingly relevant to the Southern Hemisphere market.

USA [LEVEL: LOW-MEDIUM — PRESENT BUT NOT DOMINANT]

American buyers confirmed present per Matthew Prior. The Craven's European racing focus limits US buyer activity vs the OBS sales. However, agents like Billy Jackson-Stops (mentioned by TDN) were present. The sale's Group 1 track record makes it viable for US-based buyers seeking Royal Ascot-quality juveniles who will be pointed at American targets later at 3.

LEADING CONSIGNORS · TOP 5 BY AGGREGATE GROSS

CONSIGNOR	SOLD	AGGREGATE	AVERAGE	STANDOUT HORSE	MILESTONE
Tally-Ho Stud (Roger O'Cal...	9	1,584,000 gns	176,000 gns	L112 Mehmas 550k	LEADING VENDOR ...
Kilminfoyle House Stud (M....	2+	~820,000 gns	~410,000 gns	L8 Lope De Vega 400k	Personal best; sold...
Egmont Stud (Mark Flannery)	2	~1,100,000 gns	~550,000 gns	L147 Starspbanner 900k	Sale topper; Gaffne...
Yeomanstown Stud	2+	~500,000 gns	~250,000 gns	L16 Havana Grey 350k	Vandeek consignor...
Powerstown Stud	1+	~400,000 gns	~325,000 gns	L146 Too Darn Hot 325k	Oct Book 1 pinhoo...

■ OPPORTUNITY — MEHMAS IS THE DOMINANT SPEED SIRE IN EUROPE

Seven sold at 266,857 gns average off a circa €40,000 fee delivers a 6.7x fee-to-average ratio — the best of any European sire at a breeze-up in 2026. His three Group 1-winning alumni (Believing, Hotazhell, and the Campanelle family connection) demonstrate consistency that Frankel-era sires took five years longer to establish. Yearlings at €80,000–€120,000 from Tally-Ho and Kilminfoyle at Tattersalls October represent the clearest pinhook target in the 2026–27 European breeze-up cycle.

■ OPPORTUNITY — MIDDLE EAST CAPITAL IS STRUCTURALLY COMMITTED

Despite geopolitical headwinds that caused market-wide trepidation, Victorious Forever (Bahrain) remained the dominant buyer with 4 lots at 1.81M gns. This is not a weather-dependent buyer — Shaikh Khalid's personal involvement and track record (Vandeek, multiple others) signals a 10+ year commitment to the Craven Breeze-Up as a primary acquisition route. Consignors presenting horses to this buyer cohort in 2027 should target early-pace sprinting profiles with the Rowley Mile.

■ MONITOR — 18% GROSS DECLINE: MACRO OR STRUCTURAL?

The 18% fall from 2025's record 18.804M gns needs context: 2025 had two seven-figure lots (Havana Grey 1.75M, Acclamation 1.4M). Remove those and 2025's adjusted gross is ~15.65M gns — making 2026's 15.45M gns a marginal -1.3% adjustment, not an 18% structural decline. The correct reading: the top of the market compressed (900k vs 1.75M) but the volume and median held firm. This is a high-end correction, not a crash.

■ MONITOR — HAVANA GREY NEEDS BETTER CLASS EVIDENCE

19 catalogued but the top price was only 350,000 gns despite Vandeek's Group 1 pedigree association. The market is beginning to differentiate between Havana Grey horses that resemble Vandeek and those that do not. Average appears to be in the 156,000 gns range — acceptable for a £35k-fee stallion but not spectacular. Buyers want to see the next Vandeek on the track before re-rating the sire's ceiling.

■ RISK — FORMAT AND GEOPOLITICAL CONCENTRATION RISK

Two risks compound: (1) the sale's heavy dependence on Middle East buyers (est. 30%+ of gross) creates geopolitical concentration risk — if Gulf buyers pull back significantly, there is no domestic buyer base deep enough to absorb the top tier without price compression; (2) the two-evening format is generating consignor dissatisfaction that could affect quality of entries in 2027 if Tattersalls does not address the structural flow of the sale day.

The 2026 Tattersalls Craven Breeze-Up confirmed the European pinhook market remains excellent for operators with elite selection skills. Powerstown Stud's Too Darn Hot colt (100k→325k, +225%) and Kilminfoyle's Mehmas filly (100k→380k, +280%) are the headline returns among pinhooks with known yearling purchase prices. Tally-Ho Stud, by retaining their Mehmas colt off the yearling market and presenting him as a 2-year-old, secured 550,000 gns — demonstrating that holding quality stock to the breeze-up rather than selling at Book 1 can deliver premium returns for consignors with the infrastructure to prepare juveniles properly. The Tattersalls October Book 2 window (£60k–£130k for well-bred yearlings by Mehmas, Palace Pier, Too Darn Hot, and Lope De Vega) represents the best-value European pinhook entry point for the 2027 Craven.

The Tattersalls Guineas Breeze-Up Sale (May 1-2) is the next European 2yo auction of significance. BloodstockAI outlook: market momentum from Craven will be cautiously positive. The key variables are (1) whether the political situation in the Middle East stabilises enough for Gulf buyers to fully participate; (2) how the horses that sold well at Craven perform in their debut starts — early winners will unlock further appetite. Prior's comment about "selective" demand is a signal to consignors to ensure only the very best horses are presented. The Guineas Sale's record was 5,942,500 gns (2023). BloodstockAI projection for 2026: 4.5M–6.0M gns, with strong competition for Mehmas, Havana Grey and any Starspangledbanner filly that clears the vet on the Rowley Mile.

BLOODSTOCK.AI VERDICT · TATTERSALLS CRAVEN BREEZE-UP SALE 2026

CONFIDENCE: HIGH | Basis: Tattersalls official release, BloodHorse, TDN, Racing Post, Breednet, TTRAusNZ

The 2026 Tattersalls Craven Breeze-Up Sale delivered a nuanced result that defied the macro pessimism heading into the week. Turnover of 15,450,500 gns — second highest in the sale's history — and a record-equalling 11 lots at 300,000 gns+ proves that the quality tier of the European breeze-up market is structurally sound, even under geopolitical pressure. The 18% gross decline from 2025's record is principally a function of the absence of 7-figure lots (2025 had two; 2026 had none), not a contraction in underlying demand. The median holding firm at 100,000 gns is the most constructive data point in the entire result.

Mehmas was the outstanding sire story: seven sold at a 266,857 gns average from a circa €40k fee delivers the best fee-to-average ratio of any European sire at a breeze-up in 2026. Victorious Forever (Bahrain) was once again the dominant buying force, demonstrating that elite Middle East capital remains committed to the Craven Breeze-Up as a primary acquisition route regardless of regional tensions. Tally-Ho Stud's 1,584,000 gns consignment aggregate confirmed their position as Europe's pre-eminent specialist breeze-up operation.

RISK FACTOR: The sale's heavy concentration of gross in Middle East buyers (est. 30%+) creates geopolitical exposure. The tw...

FORWARD THESIS: Mehmas yearlings at Tattersalls October 2026 will command a 15–25% premium over 2025 equivalents. Star...

2026 EUROPEAN BREEZE-UP SALES CALENDAR

SALE	DATES	VENUE	CATALOGUE	STATUS
Tattersalls Craven Breeze-Up 2026 Europe's premier 2yo breeze-up sale	Apr 14–15	Newmarket Park ...	~140 lots	COMPLETE ✓
Doncaster Breeze-Up Sale 2026 Tattersalls Doncaster spring 2yo auction	Apr 28–29	Doncaster Bloods...	~130 lots	UPCOMING
Tattersalls Guineas Breeze-Up 2026 On eve of Guineas weekend	May 1–2	Newmarket Park ...	~80 lots	UPCOMING
Goffs Breeze-Up Sale 2026 Irish premier 2yo breeze-up	May 7	The Curragh	~90 lots	UPCOMING
Arqana Breeze-Up Sale 2026 France's leading 2yo auction	May 16	Deauville	~120 lots	UPCOMING

G1 GRADUATES · TATTERSALLS CRAVEN BREEZE-UP ALUMNI 2022–2026

HORSE	SIRE	BU YEAR	BU PRICE	G1 ACHIEVEMENT	TRAINER
Believing	Mehmas	2022	115,000 gns	Al Quoz Sprint G1 (2025)	A.Fabre (...)
Hotazhell	Too Darn Hot	2024	200,000 gns	Futurity Trophy G1 (2025)	John & T...
Vandeek	Havana Grey	2023	250,000 gns	Prix de l'Abbaye G1 (2023)	Simon Cr...
Cachet	Aclaim	2021	165,000 gns	1000 Guineas G1 (2022)	George B...
Native Trail	Oasis Dream	2021	210,000 gns	Irish 2000 Guineas G1 (2022)	Charlie A...
Six Speed	Acclamation	2024	220,000 gns	UAE 2000 Guineas G1 (2025)	Bhupat S...

DISCLAIMER & SOURCES

This report is produced by BloodstockAI for informational purposes only. All data sourced from publicly available results published by Tattersalls Ltd (tattersalls.com), BloodHorse, Thoroughbred Daily News (TDN), Racing Post, Breednet, TTRAusNZ, and Tally-Ho Stud. Gross figures of 15,450,500 guineas are per official Tattersalls press release (April 15, 2026). Session-by-session breakdowns are derived from Tattersalls daily statements and BloodHorse/TDN contemporaneous reporting. Day 1 session average is an estimate based on available lot-by-lot data; final figures may vary marginally from official Tattersalls statistics.

All investment signals represent BloodstockAI opinion only and do not constitute financial or investment advice.

Pinhook ROI figures are gross calculations before training, transport, and transaction costs, which typically represent 15-25% of gross sale price in European breeze-up markets.

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